

Homonyms, homophones, and homographs

SOME WORDS HAVE THE SAME PRONUNCIATION OR SPELLING BUT MEAN DIFFERENT THINGS.

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Variations in pronunciation or spelling are what distinguish homonyms, homophones, and homographs. Using the correct word is important for both spoken and written English.

Homonyms

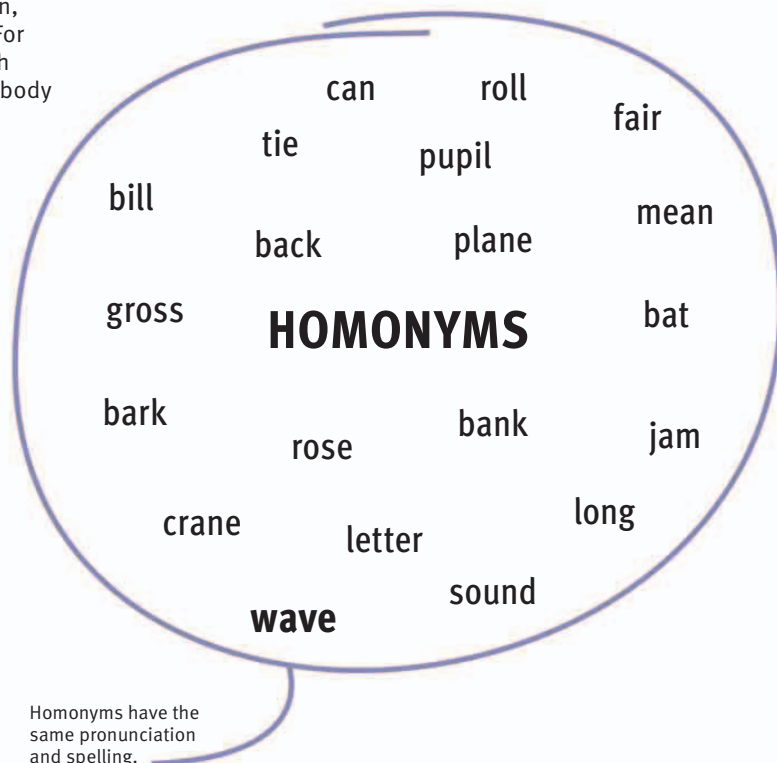
Words with the same spelling and pronunciation, but different meanings, are called homonyms. For example, the word *fair* can refer to an event with games and rides or to the idea of treating somebody in a reasonable way.

The word **homonym** come from the Greek **homos**, which means “same,” and **onyma**, which means “name.”

REAL WORLD

Crossword puzzles

Crossword puzzles can be difficult without a good understanding of homonyms, homophones, and homographs. The clues in cryptic crosswords take advantage of the confusion caused by these words in order to mislead the reader.



▷ Wave

The homonym wave has several meanings. These include the kind of wave caused by ocean currents, as well as the movement of a hand as a greeting gesture or signal.

